I also remember that every time India won, Greg could be seen leading the team to the hotel or into the team bus, but every time India lost he would thrust the players in front. In general John and Gary always preferred to stay in the background, but Greg liked to be prominent in the media.

Just months before the World Cup, Chappell had come to see me at home and, to my dismay, suggested that I should take over the captaincy from Rahul Dravid. Anjali, who was sitting with me, was equally shocked to hear him say that 'together, we could control Indian cricket for years,' and that he would help me in taking over the reins of the side. I was surprised to hear the coach not showing the slightest amount of respect for the captain, with cricket's biggest tournament just months away. I rejected his proposition outright. He stayed for a couple of hours, trying to convince me, before finally leaving.

A few days after Greg had come to my house, I suggested to the BCCI that the best option would be to keep Greg back in India and not send him with the team to the World Cup. I also said that we as senior players could take control of the side and keep the team together. That's not what happened, of course, and the 2007 campaign ended in disaster.

Greg has since written a lot of things about the Indian cricket team. Perhaps it is time to set matters straight. It came to light later that Greg was being filmed for a documentary, *Guru Greg*, during this period which went into a lot of detail about what was happening behind the scenes. It says a great deal about his tenure as coach that I and other players did not even know about this. Why were the players never asked if they felt comfortable with this? I wonder if he had permission from the BCCI to record his documentary. Wasn't it a clear infringement of the players' privacy?

While we may never get answers to these questions, suffice to say that Greg's tenure as coach was the worst of my career. There is no doubt we failed as a collective in 2007, but his high-handed manner added to our disappointment and, in the immediate aftermath of defeat, had a harmful impact on Indian cricket.

Unwelcome opinions

The outrage in India after the 2007 World Cup was not helped by armchair experts who were sitting thousands of miles away but still